Axiora – UI/UX and Brand Design Specification

Version 1.0 · Companion to the Axiora SRS · Audience: designers and AI coding agents

1. Brand Foundation

Name: Axiora (pronounced ak-SEE-oh-ra). From *axis* (the core everything turns around) and *aura*. Short, easy to say, easy to type. *Verify domain, trademark and social-handle availability before committing; fallback names: Voxlyn, Nuvexa, Cortelo, Kodara.*

Tagline options: "Intelligence, engineered." (primary) · "AI products that actually ship." · "Automate the work. Keep the craft."

Positioning: a small senior studio that builds AI systems and software end to end, from model to interface. Calm, precise, practical. Not hype.

Personality: precise, calm, direct, quietly confident. Voice is plain English, short sentences, concrete numbers, no buzzword soup (avoid "revolutionize", "cutting-edge", "unleash").

2. Logo

- **Mark:** a bold geometric **A** drawn as a single open stroke (no crossbar). In place of the crossbar sits a solid **node** (circle). Meaning: structure plus intelligence, a point of decision inside a frame.
- **Wordmark:** "Axiora" in Geist Sans SemiBold, tight tracking (-1.5%), lowercase-capital mix as written (capital A only).
- **Lockups:** horizontal (mark + wordmark), stacked, mark-only (favicon, avatars).
- **Clear space:** height of the node circle x 2 on all sides. **Minimum size:** mark 16 px, horizontal lockup 96 px wide.
- **Colors:** Ink on Paper, Paper on Ink, or single-color Mono. The node uses Signal accent only on the primary versions.
- **Never:** stretch, rotate, add shadows or gradients, recolor outside the palette, place on busy imagery without a solid backing.
- **Files to deliver:** SVG (mark, horizontal, on dark), PNG 512/1024, favicon.ico, apple-touch-icon 180, OG image 1200x630, social avatar 400x400.

- Convert the wordmark text to outlines in Figma/Illustrator before final export.

3. Design Principles (the "not vibe-coded" rules)

1. **One idea per section.** Each section has a single message and a single action.
2. **Hierarchy over decoration.** Size, weight and spacing do the work, not gradients and glows.
3. **Real content only.** No lorem ipsum, no fake logos, no invented metrics. Use real copy or clearly labeled drafts.
4. **A consistent system.** Everything uses tokens below; no one-off colors, radii or shadows.
5. **Restraint with motion.** Motion explains state changes; it is never ambient decoration.
6. **Accessible by default.** Contrast, focus, keyboard, reduced motion are part of done.
7. **Avoid template tells:** purple-to-blue gradient heroes, floating blurred orbs, glassmorphism everywhere, emoji as icons, identical three-card grids repeated down the page, centered-everything layouts, generic stock robots/brains.

4. Design Tokens

4.1 Color

Token	Light	Dark	Use
`--bg`	#F6F4EE (Paper)	#0A0F1C (Ink)	Page background
`--surface`	#FFFFFF	#111829	Cards, panels
`--surface-2`	#EEEBE3	#172036	Subtle blocks, inputs
`--text`	#0A0F1C	#F2F0EA	Primary text
`--text-muted`	#4A5163	#A3AABB	Secondary text (AA checked)
`--border`	#D9D5CA	#25304A	Lines, dividers
`--accent`	#0FA68A	#2DD4A7	Primary actions, node, links
`--accent-ink`	#04201A	#04201A	Text on accent
`--warn`	#B45309	#F59E0B	Warnings

Token	Light	Dark	Use
`--danger`	#B42318	#F97066	Errors
`--success`	#15803D	#4ADE80	Success

Rules: accent covers under 10% of any screen. Body text always ≥ 4.5:1 contrast; large text ≥ 3:1. Default theme follows system preference with a manual toggle; both themes designed, not inverted.

4.2 Typography

- **Headings and UI:** Geist Sans (fallback Inter, system-ui). **Code and labels:** Geist Mono. Self-host via `next/font`.
- **Scale (desktop / mobile):** Display 72/44, H1 56/36, H2 40/28, H3 28/22, H4 20/18, Body 17/16, Small 14, Label (mono, uppercase, +6% tracking) 12.
- **Line height:** headings 1.05–1.15, body 1.6. **Max line length:** 68 characters.
- **Weights:** 400, 500, 600 only.

4.3 Spacing, Grid, Shape

- 4 px base unit; scale 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128.
- Section vertical padding: 96 px desktop, 64 px mobile.
- 12-column grid, max content width 1200 px, gutters 24 px; prose width 720 px.
- Radius: 6 (inputs, tags), 12 (cards), 999 (pills). Borders 1 px; shadows only on floating layers (menus, modals): `0 8px 24px rgba(10,15,28,.12)`.
- Breakpoints: 480, 768, 1024, 1280, 1536.

4.4 Iconography and Imagery

- One icon set (Lucide), 1.5 px stroke, 20/24 px sizes, inherits text color.
- Imagery: real screenshots of work, architecture diagrams, team/founder photo, abstract diagrams built from the logo's node-and-line language. No generic stock.
- Diagrams and charts use accent plus neutrals only.

4.5 Motion

- Duration: 120 ms (hover/press), 200 ms (reveal), 320 ms (page/section). Easing: `cubic-bezier(.2,.7,.2,1)`.

- Scroll reveals: fade + 12 px rise, once, and only for major blocks.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: replace movement with instant or opacity-only changes.
- Hero may include one subtle interactive element (e.g. a node graph responding to cursor); must degrade to a static image.

5. Components

Every component defines default, hover, focus-visible, active, disabled, loading, error states.

- **Button:** Primary (accent fill), Secondary (outline), Ghost, Destructive. Height 44 px (min touch target), radius 6, label 15/500. Loading shows spinner and keeps width.
- **Input / Textarea / Select:** 48 px high, visible label above (never placeholder-only), helper and error text below, error uses icon + text + color.
- **Card:** surface, 1 px border, radius 12, padding 24; hover raises border color only.
- **Navbar:** sticky, 72 px, logo left, links center/right, primary CTA "Book a call". Collapses to a full-screen sheet on mobile with focus trap.
- **Footer:** sitemap columns, contact email, socials, legal links, security.txt link, copyright.
- **Tag / Badge:** mono label style.
- **Accordion (FAQ), Tabs, Tooltip, Toast, Modal/Drawer, Dropdown, Table, Pagination, Breadcrumb, Skeleton, Empty state, Stepper (estimator), File uploader, Avatar, Progress/Timeline (project milestones).**
- **Form feedback:** inline validation on blur, summary on submit failure with focus moved to the first error, success state with clear next step.
- **Cookie notice:** only if non-essential cookies are used; small, non-blocking, equal-weight Accept/Reject.

6. Information Architecture

```
/                       Home
/services               Overview
  /services/ai-automation
  /services/machine-learning
  /services/generative-ai
  /services/web-development
  /services/app-development
  /services/data-mlops
/work                   Case studies  (+ /work/[slug])
/about
/process
/insights               Blog          (+ /insights/[slug])
/contact
/book
/legal/privacy  /legal/terms
/login                  Portal login
/portal                 Client area
/admin                  Back office
```

Primary nav: Services, Work, Process, Insights, About. CTA: Book a call. Login is a quiet link in the footer and top-right utility area.

7. Page Specifications

7.1 Home

1. **Hero:** left-aligned. H1 (example): "We build AI systems that do real work." Sub-line: one sentence on what we do and for whom. Primary CTA "Book a call", secondary "See our work". Right side: product-style visual (diagram or UI crop), not a stock image.
2. **Trust strip:** tech and tooling logos (Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, LangChain, Next.js, React Native, PostgreSQL, AWS/GCP) rendered monochrome; no fake client logos.
3. **Services:** a 2-column asymmetric list (large first item), each with one-line outcome and link. Not a uniform three-card grid.
4. **How we work:** 4 steps with a connecting line and node markers (echoes logo).
5. **Selected work:** 3 items, large images, type label ("Client project" / "Founder project"), outcome line.

6. **Capabilities in numbers:** only true numbers (years of experience, projects shipped, technologies). Omit the section if numbers are not real.
7. **Founder note:** photo, 3 sentences, signature.
8. **FAQ:** 6 questions (timelines, pricing model, IP ownership, support, tech choices, NDA).
9. **Final CTA:** one headline, one button, direct email.

7.2 Service page

Hero with outcome, "Problems we solve" list, "What we deliver" list, process mini-timeline, stack, related case study, FAQ, CTA. Sticky side summary on desktop with CTA.

7.3 Case study

Summary panel (client or founder project label, role, stack, timeline), Problem, Approach, Solution (architecture diagram), Results (honest, measured), Learnings, next/previous project.

7.4 Contact and Booking

Two columns: form (left), direct contact and expectations (right: "We reply within 1 business day"). Booking page embeds scheduler with timezone shown clearly. Success page confirms and states next steps.

7.5 Auth screens

Centered single card on Paper/Ink background; logo above; fields with visible labels; show/hide password; password strength guidance; 2FA code screen with 6 auto-advancing inputs and recovery option; clear, non-revealing error text ("Email or password is incorrect").

7.6 Client Portal

- **Layout:** left sidebar (Dashboard, Projects, Files, Invoices, Support, Settings), top bar with notifications and profile.
- **Dashboard:** greeting, active project cards with progress and next milestone, recent activity, action-needed list (approve proposal, review file).
- **Project:** header (status pill, dates), tabs: Overview, Timeline, Files, Comments, Billing.
- Empty states always explain the next step.

7.7 Admin

- Dense, table-first interface with saved filters, bulk actions, keyboard shortcuts, command palette (Ctrl/Cmd+K).
- Lead detail: contact info, source, status stepper, notes, activity timeline, convert-to-client action.
- Danger zone sections separated and require typed confirmation.

7.8 System pages

Custom 404 (search + helpful links), 500, maintenance, rate-limited (429) page explaining wait time.

8. Copy Guidelines

- Headlines state outcomes, not features. Prefer verbs and numbers.
- Buttons: verb + object ("Book a call", "Send message", "View case study").
- Error messages: what happened, what to do. Never blame the user.
- Avoid: "revolutionary", "next-gen", "seamless", "leverage", "unlock the power".
- Pricing: show engagement models and starting ranges only if truthful; otherwise "Fixed-scope projects and monthly retainers; request a quote".

9. Accessibility Requirements

- WCAG 2.2 AA. Semantic landmarks, one H1 per page, logical heading order.
- Focus ring: 2 px accent + 2 px offset, always visible, never removed.
- Skip-to-content link; full keyboard operation including menus, modals, accordions.
- Labels and `aria-describedby` for errors; live regions for toasts and form results.
- Touch targets ≥ 44 px. No information by color alone. Alt text for all meaningful images.
- Test with keyboard only, screen reader (NVDA/VoiceOver), 200% zoom, and reduced motion.

10. Responsive Behavior

- Mobile-first. Navigation collapses at < 1024 px. Two-column layouts stack with the primary content first.
- Tables become cards or horizontally scroll inside their own container.
- Sticky "Book a call" bar on mobile service pages only; must not cover form fields.

11. Performance Budget (design-side)

- Hero image/diagram ⩽ 150 KB (AVIF/WebP), all images responsive with explicit width/height.
- Max 2 font families, 3 weights, subsetted, `font-display: swap`.
- No auto-playing video. Third-party scripts loaded after interaction or consent.

12. Social and Marketing Assets

- **LinkedIn banner** 1584x396, **Facebook cover** 820x312, **Instagram highlights** in accent on Ink, **avatar** = mark on Ink.
- Post templates: insight card (quote or stat), case-study card, announcement card, all built on the same grid, tokens and type.
- Handle: reserve **@axiora** (or closest) on all platforms; keep display name "Axiora".
- Email signature: name, role (Founder & CEO), site, mark; no images heavier than 20 KB.

13. Deliverables Checklist for the Design/Build Agent

1. Design tokens file (CSS variables + Tailwind config) from section 4.
2. Component library with states and Storybook or a docs page.
3. All pages in section 7 at mobile, tablet, desktop, light and dark.
4. Logo pack and favicon set; OG image generator for blog and case studies.
5. Accessibility report (axe + manual) and Lighthouse report.
6. Content pack: real copy for every page; any placeholder explicitly flagged for the CEO.

14. Definition of Done (UI)

- Uses only defined tokens and components.
- Passes AA contrast and keyboard tests in both themes.
- No layout shift on load; fonts and images optimized.
- Reviewed at 360 px, 768 px, 1280 px, 1920 px.
- No template tells listed in section 3.7.